

Use this checklist before purchasing from any aged lead vendor. If they can't answer these questions, keep shopping.

Before You Buy

- ☐ **DNC scrubbing included?**
Vendor should scrub against federal and state Do Not Call lists.
- ☐ **Replacement guarantee?**
Bad numbers, duplicates, or wrong data should be replaced free.
- ☐ **Data age disclosed?**
You should know exactly how old the leads are (30, 60, 90+ days).
- ☐ **Volume minimums?**
Understand minimum order sizes before committing.
- ☐ **Exclusive vs. shared options?**
Know if leads are sold to multiple agents or exclusive to you.

Data Quality

- ☐ **Phone validation?**
Numbers should be verified as active and callable.
- ☐ **Email verification?**
Emails checked for deliverability, not just format.
- ☐ **Address NCOA?**
Addresses run through National Change of Address database.
- ☐ **Duplicate removal?**
No paying twice for the same lead within an order.
- ☐ **Source transparency?**
Vendor discloses where the leads were originally generated.

Your First Order

- 1

Start with 50–100 leads.
Small enough to test, large enough to measure results.
- 2

Pick one vertical.
Focus on one lead type (e.g., life insurance, solar, mortgage).
- 3

Set up your CRM first.
Import leads, set follow-up tasks, tag by source.
- 4

Have scripts ready.
Don't wing it. Prepare your opening, voicemail, and objection responses.
- 5

Track everything from day 1.
Dials, contacts, appointments, closes. You can't improve what you don't measure.

Red Flags

- ⚠

No replacement policy.
If they won't stand behind their data, find someone who will.
- ⚠

Requires long-term contracts.
Good vendors let the data speak for itself. No lock-in needed.
- ⚠

Won't disclose lead sources.
Transparency about origination is a basic expectation.
- ⚠

No DNC scrubbing.
This is a compliance risk for you. Non-negotiable.

Quick Vendor Score

Checks passed (out of 10): ____

8–10 = Go | 5–7 = Proceed with caution | Below 5 = Walk away